

The Noble Dhāraṇī called the Heart of Immeasurable Life and Wisdom

Ārya Aparimitāyurjñāna Hṛdaya Nāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 850 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཚད་ཡ་ཤེས་དཔག་ཏུ་མཉམ་པའ་སྒྲི་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Heart of Immeasurable Life and Wisdom (Sanskrit: Ārya Aparimitāyurjñāna Hṛdaya Nāma Dhāraṇī; Tibetan: Phags pa tshe dpag tu med pa dang ye shes snying po zhes bya ba'i gzungs) is a short Mahāyāna sūtra, also titled in its colophon "The Noble Immeasurable Life." Set beside the lotus pond encircled by the Ganges, it records the Buddha addressing five hundred monks and a great assembly of bodhisattvas about the western world-realm of Sukhāvatī, where the buddha of immeasurable life and wisdom dwells, and it gives a dhāraṇī, or sacred incantation, associated with that buddha. As a text devoted to a dhāraṇī, it belongs to the Kangyur's collection of Tantra-class material, and it is catalogued as Toh 850 in the Kangyur.

...the world rejoiced, and praised what the Blessed One (the Buddha) had spoken.

Thus concludes the Mahāyāna sūtra called "The Noble Immeasurable Life."

In the language of India: Ārya Aparimitāyurjñāna Hṛdaya Nāma Dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī called the Heart of Immeasurable Life and Wisdom.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling beside the lotus pond encircled by the Ganges, together with a great Saṅgha of five hundred monks and a great assembly of bodhisattvas. Then the Blessed One addressed the monks, and those monks listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One said this to them:

From here, toward the western direction,
there lies the world-realm called Sukhāvatī, the Blissful.

There dwells a perfectly awakened buddha,
the Tathāgata Amitāyus, Immeasurable Life.

Whoever speaks his name
will be born in that very place.

At the time of death the Teacher

will be seen, together with the community of monks.

There, no women are to be found,
and no dwelling in a womb.

From lotuses made of precious jewels
great miraculous powers will arise.

Food and clothing and medicines,
robes, bedding, and alms bowls,
the very instant they are thought of in the mind,
will appear at once.

The buddhas who dwell in the ten directions
proclaim the praises of Sukhāvatī.

Thus the buddhas are beyond conception,
the Dharma of the buddhas is beyond conception,
the noble Saṅgha is beyond conception.

If one has faith in what is beyond conception,
the ripening of that is beyond conception,
and one will be born in a pure realm.

Monks, there is a royal city named Having Ten Thousand Leagues in a
Hundred, the palace of the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly awakened buddha
Amitāyus together with his retinue, and he was born into the warrior class.

Monks, the father of the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly awakened buddha
Amitāyus was the wheel-turning king named Supreme Excellence. His mother
was named Resplendent. His queen was the noble lady named Bhadrāpālā.
Monks, the son of the Tathāgata Amitāyus was named Moonlight, and his
attendant was named Flawless Renown.

Monks, the foremost in wisdom of the followers of the Tathāgata Amitāyus was
named Excellent Crest. The foremost in miraculous power, and foremost in
great diligence, was called Great Array. Monks, the māra of the Tathāgata
Amitāyus was named King of Offerings, and the god-given name was Faith.

Monks, the great assembly of hearers of the Tathāgata Amitāyus consists of
sixty thousand great hearers.

Monks, let all beings reflect well. Holding well the name of the Tathāgata
Amitāyus, for ten days let them meditate without distraction on recollection of
the Buddha, and continually keep in mind the Tathāgata Amitāyus who dwells
in the world-realm of Sukhāvatī. And let them also constantly recite this

dhāraṇī called the Glorious King of the Drum-Sound of Deathlessness.

Having made prostrations with the five limbs three times by day and three times by night, if all beings contemplate the Tathāgata Amitāyus, then when ten days have passed they will see the Tathāgata Amitāyus. They will also see all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, who dwell in the ten directions.

And if they dedicate all their roots of virtue toward the world-realm of Sukhāvatī, then at the time of death the Tathāgata Amitāyus will stand before them. They will be born in the buddha-field of that Tathāgata Amitāyus.

Monks, what is the dhāraṇī called the Glorious King of the Drum-Sound of Deathlessness? It is this:

Tadyathā. Śabale, abale, samajale, nirdeśe, nirjāte, niruktte, nirmukhe, jvalaparicchadani, sukhavatinirdeśe, amṛte, āyurgarbhānirhāṭi, amṛte āyuprasādhane, nirbuddhi ākāśanirdeśe, ākāśanirjāte, ākāśanirakuśale, ākāśanirdarśane, ākāśādhiṣṭhāne, sukhavatiadhiṣṭhāne, rūpanirdeśe, catvāri dharmaprasādhane, catvāri āryasatyaprasādhane, catvāri mārgabhāvanaprasādhani, balavīryaprasādhane, dharmācchedane, kuśale, kuśalanirdeśe, kuśalapraṭiṣṭhāne, buddhākuśale, viśuddhaprabhāsadharmakaraṇe, nirjati, nirbuddhe, vimale, viraje, rājase, rasāgre, rasāgrabale, rasāgra adhiṣṭhite, kule pratikule, vikule, dānte sudāntacitte, supraśāntacitte, supraṭiṣṭhite, sule sumukhi, dharme ca dharmebale ca bale, anuśa abale, buddhākāśaguṇe, buddha ākāśanirguṇe, amṛtadundubhiḥsvare svāhā.

Monks, whatever son or daughter of good family who has faith recites this dhāraṇī called the King of the Drum-Sound of Deathlessness exactly as it has been taught should put on clean clothes, and in a place that is clean and free of impurity, make offerings of flowers and incense to the Tathāgata Amitāyus. They should also bring to mind the lotus-seat at the heart of awakening and the perfect tree of awakening. And they should arouse longing for this as well; for if they cultivate longing and faith, they will be born in the buddha-field of that Tathāgata Amitāyus.

Monks, the king of trees of the Tathāgata Amitāyus is called the Jeweled Lotus of Radiance; that tree is endowed with perfect flowers and fruit. The lotus-seat is called Pure, Luminous, Beautiful, and Dazzling Rays, and it is surrounded by many jewels. Upon it the Tathāgata Amitāyus is seated. On his right is the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara; on his left is the bodhisattva Mahāsthāmaprāpta. He is surrounded by an immeasurable host of bodhisattvas.

Whatever sons or daughters of good family have abundant devotion, faith, and reverence will be born there. On a great golden ground, they will be born spontaneously within great lotuses made of the seven kinds of jewels.

Monks, whatever monk, nun, layman, or laywoman holds well the name of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Amitāyus, will not meet with the danger of fire, the danger of water, the danger of poison, the danger of weapons, the danger of yakṣas, or the danger of rākṣasas. The only exception is the ripening of previous karma.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks, together with that whole assembly, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the dhāraṇī called the Heart of Noble Immeasurable Life and Wisdom.

It was translated by the Indian preceptor Puṇyasambhava and the translator Pa tshab Nyi ma grags.

Translator's Notes

- The passage begins mid-sentence, so the opening clause is rendered as a fragment. The proper names in the family list (Supreme Excellence, Resplendent, Bhadrapālā, Moonlight, Flawless Renown, Excellent Crest, Great Array, King of Offerings) are rendered by meaning, with Bhadrapālā kept in Sanskrit as the Tibetan is a translation of it. The city name, literally "a hundred times ten thousand leagues," appears to be corrupt or garbled in this witness, and my rendering is tentative. The phrase "god-given name" is likewise obscure, probably a corrupt rendering of a name meaning "given by the gods." The "māra" of Amitāyus is as stated in the Tibetan, though the source may be a mistranslation of a sibling or rival figure.
- The dhāraṇī is a transliterated Sanskrit mantra with some corrupt readings in the Tibetan transcription, so the reconstruction offered is approximate and not a firm critical edition. "Jeweled Lotus of Radiance" and the lotus-seat name are my rendering of Tibetan titles for the tree and seat. The rākṣasa is rendered for the Tibetan srin po. The dedication of virtue in the opening line continues the sentence begun in the preceding passage.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of

spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.